decision making was hindered by corruption and rivalry between civilian and military leaders (*The News International,* 2010).

President Trump's South Asia Policy further widened the gulf between the two nations in 2017–18, especially due to divergent views on Afghanistan. The desire and plan should be to regain trust and stay closer but the interests and approaches seemed so dissimilar that strengthening ties might be incredibly difficult unless a radical shift is brought about by both countries in their approach and thinking.

The Indian factor

The US wanted Pakistan to concentrate on Al Qaeda and religious militants in Pakistan and stop worrying about India (Press Trust of India, 2009). However, very few people in Pakistan would believe that India was not a threat to Pakistan. They had the following reasons for it. The very creation of Pakistan was detested by the Congress leaders of India who dreamt of ruling *Akhand Bharat* (Undivided India). Kashmir, the eternal bone of contention between the two, three wars, the dismemberment of East Pakistan, the Siachen issue and so on speak volumes of the history of hostility and enmity between the two countries. About 80 per cent of the Pakistan Army had always been focused on countering the threat from India. Similarly, 7 out of 13 corps of the Indian army kept 'pointing their guns at Pakistan' (*The News International,* 2009).

It would not be an overstatement that Pakistani nationalism was also rooted in the resentment of India with which it had experienced some serious grievances ranging from carnage at the time of independence in 1947 to the dismemberment of East Pakistan. These grievances had been consistently reinforced by politicians and the media. The Pakistan Army's policy of strategic depth in Afghanistan also stemmed from this threat and apprehension.

The cases of secret stabbing are many. Three days after the 9/11 catastrophe, the Indian intelligence agency RAW informed the CIA that Pakistani Jihadi organisations were planning an 'imminent attack' on the White House. President Bush refused to believe without exact information. Obviously, no such information could be presented as 'it was an effort on the part of India to push the US Administration to include Pakistan on the hit list' (Abbas, 2005).[6]

Christine Fair's observations regarding India's covert operations against Pakistan were worth noticing: